credit for it. Instead, A.C.L. Carlleyle, an assistant of Cunningham who arrived there soon after, came to be considered its discoverer. The conditions of power at the time of such discoveries, the inequality in equations between well-placed British officers and their subordinates, the superior abilities of Raj officials to articulate, communicate, and disseminate news—in short the conditions within which this knowledge was produced and circulated—are likely to have submerged or rendered invisible many a 'native informant' such as Bhagwanlal Indraji. This may seem a bit like raising the old query much beloved of Indian labour historians—did British supervising engineers build the Indian railways or were they built by Indian labour? The consensus presently being that all such achievement was both unequal and collaborative, the only sensible answer to such a question now is that the necessity of moving beyond it greatly exceeds its worth.

All the Ashokan epigraphs were not discovered in the nineteenth century. Engravings of the emperor have newly appeared through the twentieth century, from Afghanistan to Andhra.[42] The discoverers have been a diverse lot, from a gold prospector who chanced upon Ashoka's Maski inscription in Karnataka in 1915 to the guru of a math in Gavimath (also in Karnataka) who, in 1931, communicated the existence of what is today called the Gavimath edict. The discovery of an Ashokan edict was made at Ratanpurwa in Bihar as recently as 2009. The road to Ashoka is so paved with good epigraphs which keep popping out of the earth at irregular intervals that there is no reason to think of Ratanpurwa as the last step in this very rocky path.[43] Various texts and Buddhist works in which Mauryan rulers figure became widely available from the middle of the nineteenth century: the testimony of the Sri Lankan Pali chronicles, the *Dipavamsa* and the *Mahavamsa*, were central to the identification of Devanampiya Piyadassi as Ashoka. But it is perhaps the sheer volume of sporadically